

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: It's time to participate in an interview!



Learning Outcome

Discuss factual and abstract information about common everyday or job related topics in both work and social contexts appropriate for the interlocutor.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever interviewed someone to get information from them? Why or why not?
- If you could interview someone, who would it be? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can interview someone about his/her professional activity.
- I can request or report facts about events or actions related to work issues.
- I can use the proper intonation in interviews.





Let's Explore!

Kristi sits down with an author. What did he **try his hand at***?

* To "try your hand at something" means to try doing something for the first time.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Kristi: Thanks for taking the time to sit down with me.

Mr. Duncan: Not a problem.

Kristi: When did you decide to be a writer?

Mr. Duncan: I didn't exactly make a decision to become a writer. Writing has always been part of who I am. A mix of different things prompted me to write. However, losing my job after my son was born was a major factor. That seemed to be the perfect time to recommit myself to being a writer full time.

Kristi: How long was it before you got published the first time and how did you make that happen?

Mr. Duncan: I just kept writing, trying everything from poetry to children's picture books, comedy sketches, and teleplays. I gave a pitch to an editor in the winter of 2010, then I turned in a submission the next year. He liked what I wrote and passed it on. It was picked up by the publisher soon after.

Kristi: What things do you think you might do next time around?

Mr. Duncan: Do differently? How much time do you have? The number one thing I wouldn't do, is spend my time revising. I would just focus more on writing, and what I bring to writing - my personal strengths.

Kristi: How would you advise aspiring authors?

Mr. Duncan: Figure out what your strengths as a writer are, make that your mantra, and then persist!

Kristi: Who or what do you look to for inspiration?

Mr. Duncan: Everything I read or see inspires me. I am constantly thinking about new ways to look at things to improve, develop, and evolve as a writer.

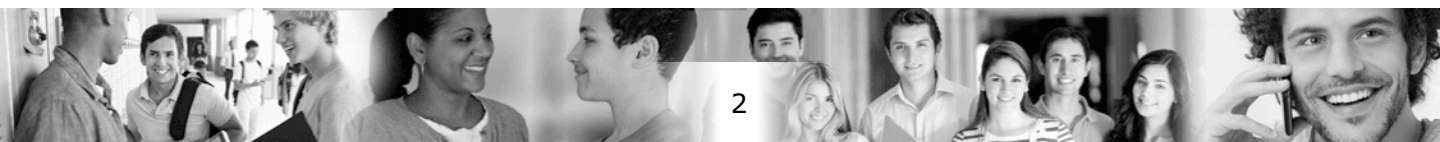
Kristi: When did you start writing professionally?

Mr. Duncan: I started about about 20 years ago.

Kristi: How do you spend your time when you aren't writing?

Mr. Duncan: I might go for walk in the city, see an exhibit, read or spend time with family.

Kristi: I think that's it. Thanks again, Mr. Duncan. I appreciate you taking the time to answer my questions.





Let's Practice!

Kristi asks some interesting questions* in her interview.

*Interview "questions" can begin with What made you...?, What advice would you...? or How long did it take...?

Instructions: Match the text in Column A with the text in column B to complete the questions correctly. Read the complete questions aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

COLUMN A

1. What made you
2. How long did it take
3. What would you
4. What advice would you give
5. What or who
6. What do you do

COLUMN B

- a. to get published the first time?
- b. an aspiring author?
- c. for fun when you are not writing?
- d. inspires or influences your writing?
- e. do differently the next time?
- f. decide to become a writer?



Let's Practice!

Mr. Duncan says writing is an aspect* of who he is.

* An "aspect" of who you are is a part or an element of your identity.

Instructions: Read the paragraph. Unscramble the mystery word. Complete the paragraph correctly. Read the paragraph aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

I didn't decide to become a _____ (erwirt). It's something I always did. It's an _____ (etcsa) of who I am. A _____ (mintboanioc) of things made me decide to _____ (riewt), but losing my job when my son was born was a major _____ (afrtoc). It was the perfect time to _____ (romitcem) myself to writing. The _____ (ubmner) one thing I'd do differently is to focus more on my _____ (stgnsetrh) as a writer, and focus more energy on _____ (rintiwg), not _____ (ngrivise).





Extension Activity

Interview someone in the working world.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Choose a person you know that you would like to know more about.
- Write down 10 questions you would ask this person about their professional experiences.
- Contact this person and set up an appointment with them.
- Ask them your questions and write down their answers.
- Remember to thank them for their time.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I write down questions that relate to a professional activity.

☐ ☐

I interview someone about their professional activity.

☐ ☐

I talk about events related to work.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **writer** (noun): someone who writes books, stories etc, as a job; author
e.g. When did you decide to be a writer?
- **to recommit** (verb): to decide to use your time for a particular purpose again
e.g. That seemed to be the perfect time to recommit myself to being a writer full time.
- **poetry** (noun): poems; the art of writing them
e.g. I just kept writing, trying everything from poetry to short stories.
- **picture book** (noun): a book which contains text and large images
e.g. I published a children's picture book in 2006.
- **comedy sketch** (noun): a short funny scene on a television show
e.g. I tried writing comedy sketches for a while.
- **teleplay** (noun): a play written for television
e.g. I wrote a teleplay for a major TV network.
- **submission** (noun): when you give something to someone for them to consider or approve
e.g. I turned in a submission in early the next year.
- **mantra** (noun): an expression that someone uses often because it conveys an idea they strongly believe
e.g. Figure out what your strengths as a writer are, make that your mantra.
- **to persist** (verb): to keep going at a task, despite obstacles or difficulties
e.g. I kept writing - I persisted.





Learning Points

Intonation in Lists, Choice Questions and Non-Final Thought Groups

Intonation is the rise and fall of your voice. There are definite and expected intonation patterns in English. The more you practice listening to and saying the correct intonation patterns, the better you will understand and be understood.

When naming items in a list, you use rising intonation for the first item in the list and falling intonation for the last. Falling intonation indicates the end of the list.

For example:

I like bananas ↗, apples ↗, pears ↗ and grapes ↘.

Rising intonation suggests that you are not finished the list.

Choice questions that use the word 'or' can either be open or closed. Each type has its own intonation pattern.

Open choice questions are yes or no questions. They have two possible intonation patterns. For example:

Does she like **Batman** ↗ or **Superman** ↗?

Does she like **Batman** or **Superman** ↘?

With the open question – asking whether the person likes either of these in general, yes or no precedes the rest of the answer :

Yes, she likes Batman .

Yes, she likes both.

No, she doesn't like either.

No, she doesn't like Batman or Superman but she likes Spiderman.

Closed choices questions are limited. With closed choice questions – asking whether a person prefers one or the other, they can only choose one of the two.

For example:

Does she like **Batman** ↗ or **Superman** ↘?

In the case, the possible answers could be:

She likes Batman.

She likes Superman.

She likes both.





Learning Points

A thought group refers to a coherent unit of speech that forms a whole. You normally separate a long sentence into several thought groups. Non-final thought groups represent all the thought groups that you say before the last thought group of a sentence. The final thought group is the thought group that ends a sentence.

You stress non-final thought groups with a normal-rising-normal pattern.

For example:

It's something I always did, ... an aspect of who I am. A combination of things made me decide to write, ... but losing my job when my son was born was a major factor.

Read the following sentences, keeping in mind the different intonation patterns you use:

Examples:

- *I am constantly thinking about new ways to look at things to improve, develop, and evolve as a writer.*
- *Who or what do you look to for inspiration?*
- *I would just focus more on writing, and what I bring to writing - my personal strengths.*

How to Master an Interview

When you attend an interview, there are certain things that you can do to master it.

1. Get ready for the big day

Research the author, type up some ideas to bring up, think about answers to common interview questions (Tell me about yourself, Why do you want this job? etc.), prepare your own questions, put together an interview kit (pens, notepad, tissues, breath mints, etc.).

2. Be your most authentic professional self

Be aware of your body language and eye contact. Try to relax and show your personality.

3. Follow other interview dos and don'ts

Arrive early, remember the name of the person you're interviewing, give them time to think of answers, send a thank-you note after the interview.

